

TATA ACQUIRES FORD'S PLANT IN SANAND

Tata Motors Electric Mobility Ltd has signed a unit transfer agreement with Ford India Private Ltd for the acquisition of the latter's manufacturing plant in Sanand, Gujarat. The agreement involves the transfer of the entire facility, including the land and buildings, the manufacturing plant along with all its machinery and all eligible employees. This agreement will cost Tata a sum of Rs 725.7 crore and the acquisition will be focused towards manufacturing Tata's electric vehicles. Ford, however, will lease back some land and buildings from Tata to continue the production of its engines which are exported to global markets. In case Ford ceases this operation as well, Tata has agreed to transfer the employees from that plant too. Tata will make the necessary investments for reconfiguring the plant to suit its needs. This would be a smooth transition as Tata's own plant in Sanand is adjacent to the Ford facility. ■

MINISTRY INTRODUCES CRASH TESTS AND SAFETY RATINGS FOR CARS

The ministry of road transport & highways (MoRTH) has announced the introduction of safety ratings for passenger vehicles through crash tests under the Bharat NCAP (New Car Assessment Program). The aim is to enable consumers to make more informed choices while buying vehicles based on the level of occupant protection offered. As per MoRTH's draft notification, these ratings will apply to the M1 vehicle category ('motor vehicles used for the carriage of passengers, comprising not more than eight seats, in addition to the driver's seat, with gross vehicle weight less than 3.5 tonnes manufactured or imported in the country'). Vehicles will be given a star rating of one to five depending on their evaluation on three main parameters—Adult Occupant Protection, Child Occupant Protection and Safety Assist Technologies. Aligned with global crash test protocols, the testing will be done at facilities in India. ■





MARUTI SUZUKI GOES THE HYBRID WAY

Maruti Suzuki will introduce some form of hybrid technology in every vehicle it launches in the next 5-7 years, says the brand's chief technical officer C.V. Raman. Not taking the direct EV route unlike other Indian automakers, Maruti is betting smart with the hybrid tech. Hybrid cars are easier to develop and produce, and their batteries are cheaper to replace in the long run as they are smaller than the massive units in EVs. ■